The rediscovery of this dated structure and its formal and iconographic parallels with the tomb of Sadan Shahid have bolstered the latter's dating to the late twelfth century.

At the necropolis of Lal Mara Sharif (Figure 6.37), located 250 km northwest of Multan toward Dera Ismail Khan but still along the Indus's alluvia, four domical structures made of brick clearly distinguish themselves from their surroundings due to their glistening, glazed-tile exterior and interior decorative programs. To date, they have been studied most intensively by Taj Ali and Holly Edwards, who attributed them either to the early eleventh-century Ghaznavid activities in the region, or to the second quarter of the thirteenth century, following the Mongol incursions.[2] However, based on our preceding analyses of the Shansabanis' pre-imperial and imperial architectural traces in Afghanistan and the revised dating of some of these structures (cf. Chapters 2–4), I consider the four tombs as part of the Shansabani affiliates' architectural patronage in the area.

Finally, two more tombs are located 450 km southwest of Multan and in the vicinity of modern Sukkur (Figures 6.33 and 6.34) – itself at the crossroads linking Panjab, Baluchistan, and Sindh (see below). They had been documented and briefly discussed by A. N. Khan (1988), and more extensively by M. Kevran (1996b), who each offered varying dates ranging from the tenth through early thirteenth centuries, again based on stylistic analysis and comparison with earlier structures.[3] But I propose that these tombs also be dated to the last two decades of the twelfth century, and thus considered part of the corpus of Shansabani-period funerary structures in the middle Indus region (see full discussion below). Collectively, then, all three of these architectural groups are invaluable sources for the nature of empire-building undertaken by Mu'izz al-Din and his dependents as they followed the geo-political momentum radiating eastward from Ghazna.

As will be discussed throughout this chapter, the structures attributable to Shansabani patronage in the Indus region evince an astounding variety in formal styles and also materials of construction. The one uniting factor among them, however, is the overall westward *qibla* orientation of the buildings with *mihrab*s (only the tombs of Sadan Shahid and Ahmad Kabir lacked *mihrab*s altogether). Precise coordinates are not available for these complexes but, based on the observations in Chapter 4 regarding pre-modern *qibla* orientations, it is fair to say that the *qibla*s of Shansabani-patronized buildings at the western edges of the Indic world – that is, Sindh and along the upper Indus's shores – were probably neither accurate nor consistent.

The general westerly direction of the surviving *mihrab*s, however, would indicate the *qibla* preferred by the Hanafis. This *madhhab* had remained dominant among the later Ghaznavid sultans despite Sultan Mahmud's leaning toward the Shafi'iyya.[4] Although, it should be noted that no